



Artificial Intelligence Foundations (CIS4049-N)

Week 1 – What's AI – Part 3

Module Leader: Dr. Alessandro Di Stefano

Email: A.DiStefano@tees.ac.uk

School of **Computing, Engineering & Digital Technologies**

tees.ac.uk

A short History of AI

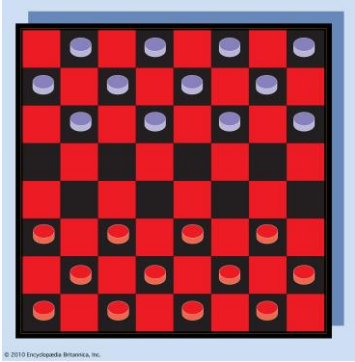
Birth of AI

- **1956:** Workshop at Dartmouth College; attendees: John McCarthy, Marvin Minsky, Claude Shannon, etc.

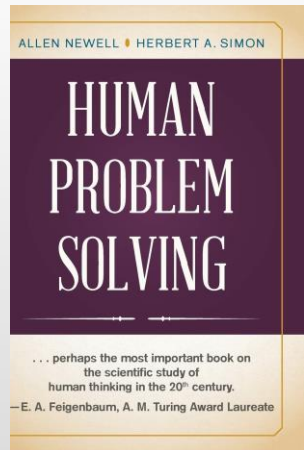


- **Aim** for general principles: Every aspect of **learning** or any other feature of **intelligence** can be so precisely described that a **machine** can be made to simulate it.

Birth of AI



- **1952 - Checkers:** Samuel's program learned weights and played at strong amateur level



- **1955 - Problem Solving:** Newell & Simon's Logic Theorist: prove theorems in Principia Mathematica using search and heuristics; later, General Problem Solver (GPS)

Overwhelming Optimism

- *“Machines will be capable, within twenty years, of doing any work a man can do.”*
— Herbert Simon
- *“Within 10 years the problems of artificial intelligence will be substantially solved.”*
— Marvin Minsky
- *“I visualize a time when we will be to robots what dogs are to humans, and I’m rooting for the machines. “*
— Claude Shannon

.. underwhelming Results

- Example: **machine translation**.

“The spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak”. (Russian)



“The vodka is good, but the meat is rotten”.

- **1966**: ALPAC report cut off government funding for MT - **First “AI winter”**

Implications of early era

- **Problems:**
 - **Limited computation:** search space grew exponentially, outpacing hardware ($100! \approx 10^{157} > 10^{80}$)
 - **Limited information:** complexity of AI problems (number of words, objects, concepts in the world)
- **Contributions:**
 - **Lisp** (1958), garbage collection, time-sharing (John McCarthy)
 - **Key paradigm:** separate **modeling** and **inference**

Knowledge-based Systems

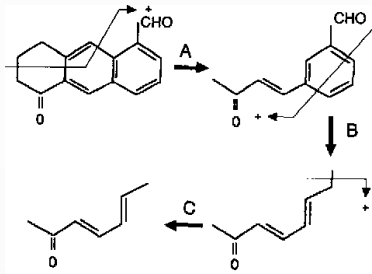


- **70-80s: Expert Systems** - elicit specific domain knowledge from experts in form of rules:

if [premises] then [conclusion]

Knowledge-based Systems

- **DENDRAL**: infer molecular structure from mass spectrometry



- **MYCIN**: diagnose blood infections, recommend antibiotics
- **XCON**: convert customer orders into parts specification;
save DEC \$40 million a year by 1986

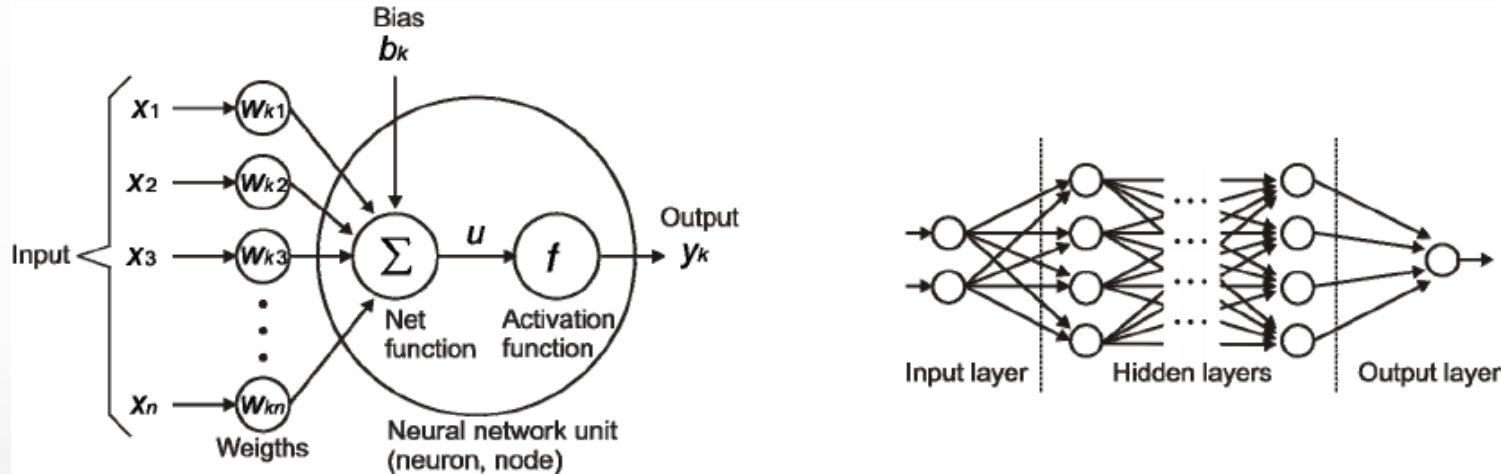


Knowledge-based Systems

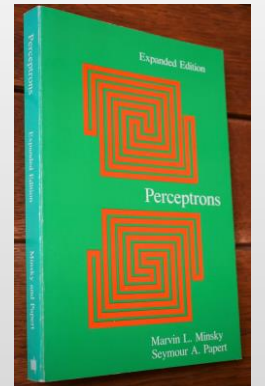
- **Contributions:**
 - First **real application** that impacted industry
 - Knowledge helped curb the exponential growth
- **Problems:**
 - Knowledge is not deterministic rules, need to model **uncertainty**
 - Requires considerable **manual effort** to create rules, hard to maintain
- **1987:** Collapse of Lisp machines - **second AI winter**

Artificial Neural Networks

- **1943: artificial neural networks**, connect neural circuitry and logic (McCulloch/Pitts)

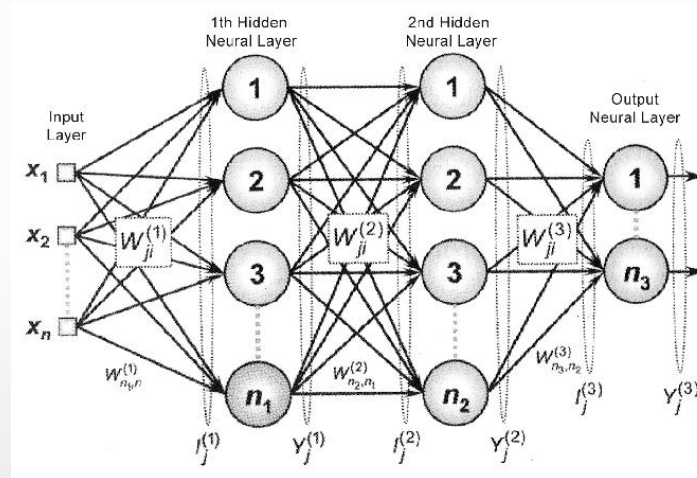


- **1969: Perceptrons** book showed that linear models could not solve XOR, killed neural nets research (Minsky/Papert)

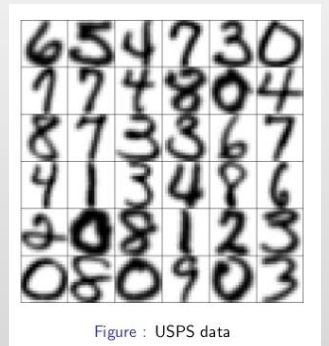


Training Networks

- **1986:** popularization of backpropagation for training multi-layer networks (Rumelhardt, Hinton, Williams)



- **1989:** applied convolutional neural networks to recognizing handwritten digits for USPS (LeCun)



-
- A 10x10 grid of 100 small, square images. Each image is a different scene or object, likely generated by a deep learning model. The images show a wide variety of subjects, including landscapes, animals, people, and abstract patterns. The style is somewhat blurry and artistic, characteristic of early generative models. The grid is organized into 10 rows and 10 columns, with each cell containing a single image. The images are small, approximately 100x100 pixels each. The overall composition is a dense, colorful mosaic of diverse visual information.

